

# Venue Booking System — For Administrators

Keeping venues and the timetable accurate, reviewing bookings that need a human decision, managing CRs and fellow Admins, and communicating through notifications and announcements.

**Audience** Campus Admins & Super Admins · **Covers** Morogoro Main, Dar es Salaam, Tanga, Mbeya · **Companion document** User Manual (Part 1) · **Live system** tafutavenue-web.vercel.app

**CAMPUS SCOPING, IN ONE LINE**

As a regular Admin, everything below is automatically limited to your own campus. A Super Admin sees the same screens across all four campuses at once — see §2.12.

## 2.1 Logging in as Admin

Same login page as everyone else — the system recognizes your account as Admin and takes you straight to the Admin Dashboard instead of the CR one.

## 2.2 Dashboard

Your at-a-glance view: bookings by status, the most-booked venues, total venues and CRs on your campus (or, for a Super Admin, broken down **by campus**), and a male/female split. Filter by **date range** (today, yesterday, this week, this month, or all time) and by **semester**. Stat cards are clickable shortcuts straight into the filtered list behind them.

## 2.3 Managing venues

Open **Venues** to see, search, and filter every venue on your campus. The list starts at 9 venues, with a **Show More** button to reveal the rest once you've searched or filtered down to what you want.

### Adding a venue

|                           |                                                                             |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Name / Code               | How it's identified — code is optional but must be unique if set.           |
| Building, Faculty         | Optional location context.                                                  |
| Capacity, Type            | Lecture Hall, Laboratory, Seminar Room, Hall, or Other.                     |
| Blocked Purposes          | Purposes this venue should never be booked for (e.g. no Meetings in a lab). |
| Restricted Levels / Dept. | Limit who's allowed to book it — e.g. Masters-only, or one department only. |

Edit or delete a venue from the same list at any time. Deleting only removes the venue record — any booking history tied to it is preserved separately.

## 2.4 Importing the timetable

Two ways to load the official lecture schedule for a semester, both on the Venues page:

### From a link

Paste the Mzumbe timetable URL for your campus and semester — the system fetches it directly, creating any venues it doesn't already know about along the way.

### From a CSV file

Upload a spreadsheet with columns for day, time, venue, course, lecturer, and program — useful when a link isn't available.

#### ADD VS. REPLACE

**Add** layers the new schedule on top of what's there (matching entries are skipped). **Replace** clears the existing schedule for that semester and campus first — use it when re-importing a corrected file, not when adding a second batch.

### Clearing a timetable

Wipes the schedule for one semester and campus, and removes venues auto-created for it that are no longer needed — venues still used in another semester, or with real CR bookings, are kept automatically.

## 2.5 Reviewing bookings

Open **Bookings**. Tabs across the top — Pending, Approved, Rejected, Cancelled, All — each show a live count.

- **Search** live by venue name, CR name, time, purpose, or booking reason.
- A booking with a **View Reason** tag was a CR's 3rd-or-later booking that day — open it to read their full explanation before deciding, at any time, even after you've already approved it.
- **Approve** a pending booking directly, or **Reject** with a short reason the CR will see. Either way, the CR is notified immediately.
- **Delete** removes a single booking permanently; **Delete All** does the same for every booking matching your current filter — both irreversible.
- **Download Report** generates a PDF of bookings matching your current Status filter. Optionally pick a specific **date** next to it, for a report scoped to just that day.

## 2.6 Booked Venues

A read-focused view of what's occupying venues: **Booked Venues for a Specific Day** (a card per booking, including the CR's signature) or **Booked History (All)** as a table. Same status filter and live search as Bookings.

## 2.7 Semesters

Create a semester with its name, academic year, semester number, and start/end dates. **Activate** the current one — only one semester is active at a time, and it's what Find Venue and the timetable import screens use by default.

## 2.8 Managing CRs

Open **Students (CR)**. Filter by Campus, Faculty, Department, Program, Level, Year, or Sex, plus free-text search — the count of matching CRs updates live. A **Pending only** toggle filters the list down to accounts awaiting your decision, and pending accounts always sort to the top of the list by default, so they're never missed among already-active ones.

- **Approve / Reject** — shown in place of Edit/Remove for a pending (self-registered, not-yet-approved) account. Approve activates it immediately; Reject permanently deletes it (a still-pending account has no booking history worth keeping, unlike Remove below).
- **Add CR** — register one CR at a time, the same Reg No/manual-email choice as self-registration; an Admin-added CR is active immediately, with no approval step.
- **Import CSV** — register many at once; download the template first. Rows with a duplicate or invalid Reg No are skipped and listed, not silently dropped.
- **Edit** — update any detail, including their Reg No if it was entered incorrectly; if you change their name or Reg No and they have one set, their email is regenerated and they're notified.
- **Remove** — a soft removal for an already-active CR: personal details are cleared and they show as "Deleted CR #id" going forward, but their full booking history is kept for records.
- **Print List** — a PDF of exactly the CRs your current filters show.

Each CR's Campus badge is color-coded, so mixed lists stay easy to scan.

## 2.9 Managing admins

Open **Admins** — visible to Super Admins only. Add a new Admin with a name, email, password, and a required Campus — the one campus they'll manage from then on. Editing lets you reassign their Campus. Removing an Admin is available to any Super Admin, for any Admin except one — see §2.12.

## 2.10 Activity logs

Open **Logs** for a running record of what's happened: logins, bookings, approvals, edits. Filter by action type, and delete a single entry or everything matching the current filter.

### WHAT EACH ROLE CAN SEE

CR and regular-Admin actions are visible to every Admin. A Super Admin's own actions are visible only to that Super Admin — not to other Admins.

## 2.11 Settings & branding

Any Admin can set the **Main System Color** and upload an **App Logo**, and configure **Study Unit Booking Hours** — the allowed start/end time per day of the week, which every CR's booking form respects. **My Color Preference** here is personal to your own account.

## 2.12 Super Admin duties

Everything above, across all four campuses at once, plus:

### App Branding

Only a Super Admin can set the **App Name** shown on the login page, the university **Support Phone** number, the **Footer Text/Link**, and the **Login Page Background Color**.

### Promoting an Admin

When adding or editing an Admin, a Super Admin can tick **Make this a Super Admin** instead of assigning a campus — a promoted Super Admin manages Admins and sees all campuses, but cannot edit, demote, or remove the one **Main Super Admin**, and no Super Admin can remove their own account.

### THE MAIN SUPER ADMIN IS PROTECTED

This one account can't be edited, demoted, or removed by anyone but itself, and doesn't appear in anyone else's Admins list. It's the fallback that guarantees the system can never be locked out of.

## Database Maintenance

After certain system updates, a one-time setup step is needed on the server. Under **Settings -> Database Maintenance**, press **Run Database Migrations** to apply it. Use this if something that used to work suddenly shows a server error right after an update.

## 2.13 Notifications

The bell icon in the top bar shows how many notifications you haven't read yet, as a number. Click it to open your **Notifications** inbox.

- **Booking Pending** — a CR on your campus has requested a 3rd-or-later booking that day and needs your decision. Click it to jump straight to the **Pending** tab on Bookings, ready to approve or reject.
- **CR Pending Approval / Staff Pending Approval** — a new self-registration on your campus needs your decision (§2.8, §2.16). A Staff Admin only ever sees the Staff version, and vice versa for a general Admin.
- **Announcement** — something another Admin on your campus (or a Super Admin) has broadcast.

Filter your inbox by **type**, **read/unread** status, a specific **date**, or search by keyword. Click any notification to mark it read and reveal its full message, or use **Mark all as read** to clear everything at once. You can also **delete** any notification from your own inbox that you no longer need.

## 2.14 Announcements & the marquee

Open **Announcements** in the sidebar to see every announcement posted on your campus (all campuses, for a Super Admin), each with who posted it, how many people received it, and how many have read it so far. You can **Edit** or **Delete** your own posts at any time — editing updates the message for everyone who already has it, deleting removes it from their notifications entirely. You can see, but not edit or delete, an announcement posted by a colleague.

### Posting an announcement

Press **New Announcement**, then choose the **Audience**:

- **CRs** — goes to CRs on your campus (a Super Admin may pick a specific campus, or leave it as **All Campuses**). Optionally narrow it further by **Faculty**, **Department**, **Program**, **Level**, or **Year of Study**.
- **Staff** — goes to Staff on your campus, the same campus-scoping rule as CRs. A Staff Admin's announcements only ever reach Staff, never CRs.
- **Admins** — goes to fellow Admins, optionally narrowed to one campus.

After sending, you'll see how many people it reached.

### The marquee (scrolling banner)

Every announcement a CR or Staff member has received also scrolls across the top of their dashboard as a marquee banner, so it's seen even before they open Notifications. Under **Settings**, any Admin can switch the marquee **On/Off** and optionally set a **show until** date/time, after which it hides itself automatically without needing to be turned off manually.

## 2.15 Staff Admin & Super Staff Admin

Alongside the general Admin track (CRs, venues, timetable), the system has a second, entirely separate **Staff Admin** track for managing Staff accounts and activity. A Staff Admin's sidebar mirrors a general Admin's — Staff, Notifications, Announcements, Venues, Bookings, Booked Venues, Settings — but every screen is scoped to Staff data only; a Staff Admin never sees a CR, a student booking, or student-only settings anywhere in the system, and a general Admin's sidebar no longer shows a Staff entry at all.

A **Super Staff Admin** is the Staff-track equivalent of a Super Admin: they oversee Staff accounts and activity across all four campuses, and can create additional Staff Admins (also confined to the Staff track) from the Admins page — the same way a general Super Admin creates general Admins. A Staff Super Admin cannot see or manage any general-domain Admin, and vice versa.

### WHO CAN CREATE A STAFF ADMIN?

Only a Super Admin (general) or a Super Staff Admin can add a new Staff Admin, from the Admins page — the same screen used for general Admins, with a domain choice available to a general Super Admin.

## 2.16 Managing Staff & approving pending accounts

Open **Staff** (visible to both a general Admin, for oversight, and a Staff Admin, as their primary screen). It works the same way as Students (CR) — see §2.8 — with a **Pending only** filter, pending-first sorting, and **Approve/Reject** in place of Edit/Remove for a not-yet-approved account.

- **Add Staff** — register a Staff member directly; the account is active immediately, with no approval step, and the password is shown once on screen (not emailed).
- **Edit / Remove** — same behavior as for CRs: Remove is a soft removal that clears personal details but keeps booking history.

## 2.17 Registration windows (CR & Staff)

Under **Settings**, both CR and Staff self-registration can be controlled per campus, in two ways that work together:

- **Open / Closed toggle** — an immediate, manual switch. A regular Admin only sees and controls their own campus; a Super Admin (or Super Staff Admin, for the Staff toggle) sees and controls all four, individually or all at once.
- **Scheduled window** — an optional **Open from** / **Open until** date and time per campus, for automatically opening or closing registration at a specific moment without needing to remember to flip the toggle yourself. Leave both blank to leave a campus unaffected by scheduling.

When registration is closed for the campus a visitor selects on the Register page — whether by the toggle or by being outside the scheduled window — the rest of the form is replaced with a plain "Registration is closed" message, instead of a fillable-but-rejected form. If both CR and Staff are closed on every campus at once, the whole Register page shows a single closed notice.

## 2.18 Maintenance Mode

Under **Settings**, any Admin (general or Staff, super or not) can switch on **Maintenance Mode**, optionally with an **expected back until** date/time. While on, any ordinary CR or Staff member trying to log in is told the system is under maintenance and cannot proceed. Every Admin account, of any kind, is completely unaffected and can keep logging in and working as normal — this is what lets an Admin turn maintenance back off once the issue is resolved.

## 2.19 Suspending accounts by campus

Under **Settings**, a **Suspend CR/Staff Accounts by Campus** tool lets an Admin lock out every currently-active account of their kind (CR for a general Admin, Staff for a Staff Admin) on a chosen campus in one action — useful for an operational issue affecting a whole campus. A confirmation is required before it runs. A matching **Reactivate** action restores exactly the accounts that were suspended this way. Admin accounts are never touched by this tool, so Admins can always log in normally to run it in either direction.

## § Roles & permissions, at a glance

| CAN DO THIS...                                 | CR  | ADMIN          | SUPER ADMIN      |
|------------------------------------------------|-----|----------------|------------------|
| Book a venue on their own campus               | Yes | —              | —                |
| Approve / reject bookings                      | —   | Own campus     | Any campus       |
| Add / edit venues & timetable                  | —   | Own campus     | Any campus       |
| Add / edit / remove CRs                        | —   | Own campus     | Any campus       |
| Add / edit / remove Admins                     | —   | —              | Yes*             |
| Post an announcement to CRs                    | —   | Own campus     | Any campus       |
| Post an announcement to Admins                 | —   | Yes            | Yes              |
| Edit / delete an announcement                  | —   | Own posts only | Own posts only** |
| Change App Name, Support Phone, Login branding | —   | —              | Yes              |
| Run database migrations                        | —   | —              | Yes              |

\*Except the Main Super Admin, who cannot be edited, demoted, or removed by anyone else. \*\*Even a Super Admin cannot edit or delete an announcement posted by another Admin — only its own author can.

A Staff Admin / Super Staff Admin has the same shape of access as an Admin / Super Admin above, but entirely within the separate Staff track (§2.15) — never CR/student data, and never visible to or from the general Admin track.

## § Troubleshooting

### "A CR says they can't book a venue that looks free."

Check Booked Venues for that day/venue — an official timetable slot or another pending booking may already occupy it.

### "Adding/editing something suddenly shows a server error."

A recent update may need a one-time database step — go to Settings -> Database Maintenance -> Run Database Migrations (Super Admin only, §2.12).

### "I can't find a particular Admin in the list."

If it's the Main Super Admin, that's expected — their account is intentionally hidden from everyone else, by design. If it's a Staff Admin, check the Admins page's domain filter — a general Super Admin can view either track.

### "Why can't I edit this announcement?"

Only the Admin who originally posted it can edit or delete it — even a Super Admin can only manage their own. You can still read it, and see how many people it reached, from the Announcements page.

### "A CR/Staff account is stuck as pending."

Open Students (CR) or Staff, turn on **Pending only**, and Approve or Reject it — see §2.8 / §2.16.

### "Users say they can't log in and see a maintenance/suspension message."



Check Settings -> Maintenance Mode (§2.18) and the campus suspension tool (§2.19) — one of these may still be switched on from a previous incident. Your own Admin login is never affected by either.